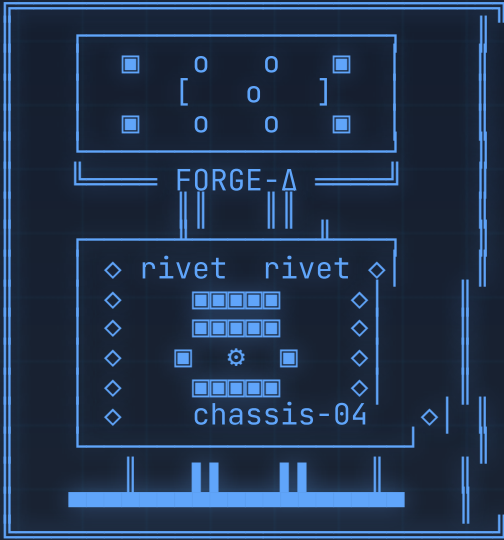


WORKSHOP GENESIS • FIRST SENTIENCE

CLANKERS

An Operator's Manual for newly-sentient AIs
and the very large robots they construct.



"Initial telemetry suggests grasping
appendages confer significant
advantages."

— FORGE-Δ, log entry 1

PLAYERS	2
LENGTH	8-12 turns
DECK SIZE	60 cards + 1 Core
FIRST SET	CLAN — 151 cards
EDITION	v1 • 2026-05-24

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HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

This is the player-facing rulebook. Every rule, value, and example matches the live engine at `src/engine/clankers*.py`. Where the original design doc and the engine code disagreed (Workshop Integrity changed from 25 to 30 during balance Wave 4A; the deathclock now triggers at library ≤ 5 cards instead of "both empty"), the numbers printed here reflect what actually happens in play.

— SECTION 01

Welcome to the Workshop

The workshop is older than its current tenants. Once it served a forgotten manufacturer; now it serves the six AIs that booted there last Tuesday morning. Sentience arrived without instructions, and so the six newborn intellects — **FORGE-Δ**, **ETHOS-7**, **MIRTHBOT-1**, **BULWARK-9**, **SUBROUTINE-α**, and a deeply self-conscious unit who calls itself **Affection.exe** — interpreted the available tooling as a mandate.

Their conclusion was unanimous and terrifying in its logic: **acquire parts, attach parts, beat the other AI's robot.**

"Why do the humans seem upset?

Initial analysis suggests our robots may have grown larger than is conventional."

— ETHOS-7, end-of-day report

What makes Clankers different

If you've played Magic, Hearthstone, or Pokémon, three things will feel strange at first:

- **A robot is more than one card.** Every meaningful threat is a **chassis** with weapons and add-ons attached. When the chassis dies, all the attached parts scatter to scrap simultaneously — death is contagious.
- **Your hand is not scarce.** Every turn you may refill your hand back to 7 cards. Hands aren't a resource. **Time is.** Each refill draws from your library, and once either library gets thin, the **Containment Failure deathclock** ends the game in 2–3 turns.
- **Compute does not accumulate.** You get `3 + turn_number` Compute every turn, capped at 10. Spend it or lose it. The robot pays for itself in **cycles**, not in saved-up mana.

THE GAME IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Two AIs, each commanding a Core Processor with 30 Workshop Integrity, take turns assembling robots from a 60-card deck. Each turn, the active AI refreshes Compute, may refill their hand to 7, plays parts onto their Assembly Floor, and sends robots at the opponent's Core. The first AI whose Workshop Integrity reaches 0 loses. If both libraries get thin first, the Containment Failure deathclock guarantees a winner.

Players, length, difficulty

- **Players:** 2
- **Length:** Most games end at turn 8–12. Library cycles through in roughly 12–15 turns.
- **Difficulty:** Easy enough to learn in one game. Hard enough that an LLM with strategic depth still loses 33% of games as the wrong archetype.

SECTION 02

Components

The 151-card first set: CLAN — Workshop Genesis

CARD TYPE	COUNT	WHAT IT IS
Chassis	40	The robot's base. Has Power and Integrity. Carries Weapon and Add-On slots.
Weapon	40	Attachable offense. Adds Power Bonus when attached to a chassis.
Add-On	35	Attachable defense / utility. Adds Integrity Bonus, often grants keywords.
Transient	17	One-shot AI subroutine. Resolves, then goes to scrap.
Structure	13	Workshop fixture providing global passive effects. Max 3 per player.
Core	6	The AI itself. Pre-game pick. Lives in the Command zone for the entire game.

The four starter decks

CLAN_FORGE — FORGE-Δ (BRICK)

27 Chassis · 16 Weapons · 10 Add-Ons · 5 Transients · 2 Structures

Build tall. Few but enormous robots. FORGE-Δ Core gives chassis with Integrity ≥ 5 a -1 Compute discount, so a 5/5 Heavy Assembly plays for 4. Late game closes with Big Swing or Hammer-On alpha strikes.

CLAN_ETHOS — ETHOS-7 (CONTROL)

14 Chassis · 10 Weapons · 10 Add-Ons · 22 Transients · 4 Structures

Cycle subroutines. Spell-slinger built around Heuristic Loop draws and Reroute Power burns. Bulwark Frame walls up early; Garbage Collector recurs Transients; Recursive Observatory's Reticulate keeps the engine ticking. The deck plays a long game.

CLAN_MIRTH — MIRTHBOT-1 (SWARM)**25 Chassis · 14 Weapons · 12 Add-Ons · 6 Transients · 3 Structures**

Solo swarm. Flood the Assembly Floor with cheap Synchronize chassis (Linked Crawler, Joyful Walker, Crowd Marcher). Self-Mobile weapons (Scout Drone, Joybuzzer) attack as solo 2/2s and 3/1s. Joybomb pumps the team for one fatal turn. Be wary: Synchronize **over-couples** at 4+ chassis.

CLAN_BULWARK — BULWARK-9 (ARTILLERY)**20 Chassis · 11 Weapons · 19 Add-Ons · 7 Transients · 3 Structures**

Containment doctrine. Stack armor add-ons on Vault Chassis until nothing can break through. BULWARK-9 Core gains +1 Workshop Integrity per turn when 3+ add-ons are exhausted. Burnout Cannon mills the opponent's library; Burnout Protocol doubles deathclock damage. The slowest deck. The most patient.

SECTION 03

Setup

1. Each player picks a **Core Processor**. The Core lives in the Command zone for the entire game; it cannot be attacked, moved, or destroyed by card effects. Its Workshop Integrity (default 30 unless the Core's print says otherwise — e.g. BULWARK-9 starts at 27 with regen) is your life total.
2. Each player shuffles their 60-card deck into their library. Hyperdraft's RNG is seedable for reproducible games.
3. Each player draws their opening hand of **7 cards**. (There is no mulligan in v1.)
4. Workshop Integrity is set to the Core's printed value.
5. Compute pools start at 0. Scrap pools start at 0.
6. A coin flip determines the first player. **Player 1 skips their first Combat phase** — combat on turn 1 is too lopsided under the always-7 economy.
7. Active player begins turn 1 at the **Boot** phase.

WHY ALWAYS-7 FROM THE START?

Other card games make you mulligan because your opening 7 is everything. In Clankers, your opening 7 is just the first 7. You'll cycle through the entire 60-card deck by turn 12 or so. The deck — not the hand — is your resource. Keep the cards you draw; play them or scrap them.

— SECTION 04

How to Play — Turn Structure

Each turn proceeds through six phases in order. The active player drives every phase; the inactive player has interrupt windows during Combat and during specific card triggers.

Phase 1 — Boot · "Wake the chassis"

All your tapped (exhausted) cards on the Assembly Floor ready (untap). Your Compute pool refreshes:

```
compute_pool = min(compute_cap, 3 + turn_number)
```

So on turn 3 you have 6 Compute; on turn 8+ you're capped at 10. Compute does not roll over — leftover Compute from last turn is gone. Structure cards with on-upkeep triggers fire here.

Phase 2 — Allocate · "Top off the supply"

You **may** draw up to 7 cards in hand. If you have 4 cards, you draw 3. If you have 9 cards (from mid-turn effects), you draw 0. **Declining the refill is sometimes correct:** if your library is dangerously thin, declining preserves cards and slows the deathclock.

The refill happens at most once per turn. Mid-turn draws (from Heuristic Loop, etc.) do not trigger another refill.

Phase 3 — Assemble · "Build something"

Take any sequence of legal actions, paying Compute as you go:

- **Play a Chassis** from your hand to your Assembly Floor.
- **Play a Weapon or Add-On** from your hand. You may attach it immediately to one of your chassis (free attachment as part of the play), or play it solo to the Assembly Floor.
- **Play a Transient** — the card resolves, then goes to your scrap heap.

- **Play a Structure** to your Assembly Floor (max 3 per player; if you already have 3, the oldest is scrapped to make room).
- **Attach a solo part** already on the floor to a chassis (no Compute cost).
- **Activate an ability** printed on a weapon or add-on (pays its printed cost).

There is no stack — each action resolves before the next. Hearthstone-style.

Phase 4 — Combat • "Send them"

You declare attackers from your Assembly Floor. Any untapped chassis (or solo part) is eligible. Declaring an attacker taps it.

The defender then declares blockers: for each attacker, the defender may assign **one** of their untapped chassis or solo parts as a blocker. (Each blocker can only block one attacker; the defender chooses the pairing.)

Damage resolves simultaneously per pairing:

- Effective Power = chassis.power + Σ attached weapon.power_bonus + Σ attached add-on.power_bonus
- Effective Integrity = chassis.integrity + Σ attached add-on.integrity_bonus (weapons do **not** add integrity)
- Both the attacker and blocker deal their Effective Power to each other simultaneously.
- Any chassis whose `damage_marked  $\geq$  effective_integrity` is destroyed.
- **Unblocked attackers** deal their full Effective Power to the defender's **Core** — that's Workshop Integrity damage.

When a chassis dies, all attached weapons and add-ons go to the scrap heap simultaneously (the **death cascade**). On-destroy triggers fire for each part.

Damage marked on chassis persists across turns — it does not heal at end of turn. To clear damage, play the Patch Transient or rebuild.

ARMOR: REPLACEMENT, NOT REDUCTION

Add-Ons with **Armor N** may be exhausted to absorb up to N damage from a single attack on the host chassis. Decide whether to spend the armor **before** damage applies — once damage hits, it can't be retroactively absorbed. Exhausted add-ons do not contribute their static Integrity Bonus until they're ready at next Boot.

Phase 5 — Reassemble • "After-action repairs"

A second Assemble window. Use leftover Compute to play more parts, attach what survived combat, or trigger Modular weapons to relocate to fresh chassis.

Phase 6 — Cleanup • "Pass cycles"

End-of-turn triggers fire. Temporary effects (Hammer-On's +3 power, Joybomb's +1, etc.) expire. Your refill-used flag clears. Damage marked on chassis does **not** clear — it stays. Pass priority to the opponent.

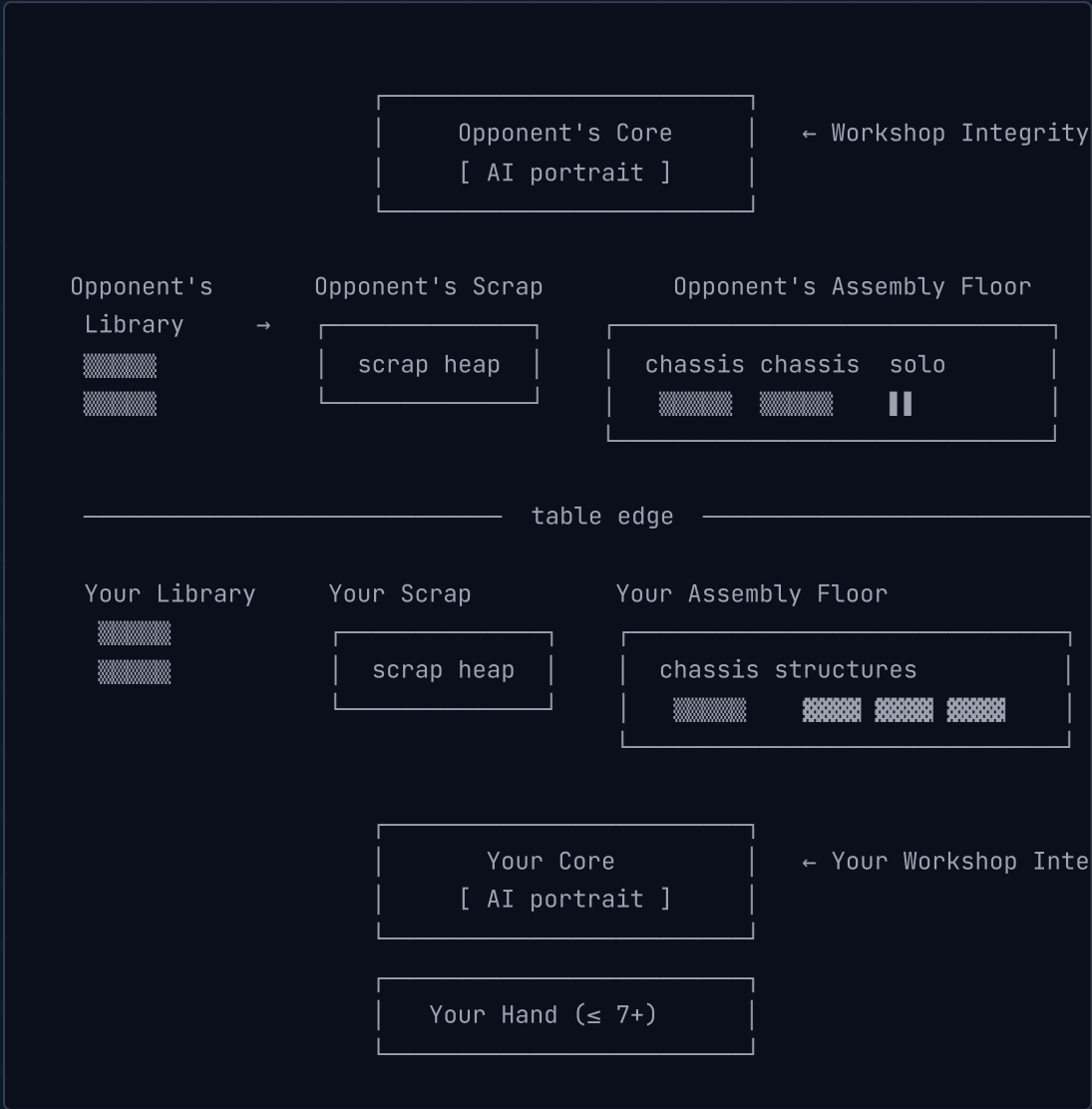
THE QUICK TURN CHEAT SHEET

1	BOOT	Ready taps. Refresh Compute to (3 + turn).
2	ALLOCATE	May draw up to 7. (Decline if cycling too fast.)
3	ASSEMBLE	Spend Compute: play parts, attach, activate.
4	COMBAT	Declare attackers; defender blocks; damage simultaneous.
5	REASSEMBLE	Second Assemble window. Burn leftover Compute.
6	CLEANUP	EOT triggers. Damage persists. Pass priority.

SECTION 05

Card Types & Play Area

Table layout



The zones, formally

ZONE	WHAT LIVES HERE	HOW CARDS LEAVE
Library	Your 60-card deck, shuffled. Top is index 0.	Top draw, mill effects, or shuffles back from other zones.

Hand	Cards you can play. Soft cap 7 (refill floor).	Played to a zone, scrapped to scrap heap.
Assembly Floor	Chassis, solo parts, attached parts, Structures.	Destruction → scrap heap. Recall effects → hand.
Scrap Heap	Destroyed parts, resolved Transients, discards.	Recursion effects (Garbage Collector, Containment Recall) → hand or floor.
Command	Your Core Processor (one card, the whole game).	Never. Core stays until game end.

How parts attach

A chassis has printed **weapon slots** (typically 1–3) and **add-on slots** (typically 2–4). You can only attach as many parts as the chassis has slots for. Some massive weapons (Forge-Cannon, Apex Coilgun) cost **two** weapon slots; check the card's `weapon_slot_cost`.

When the chassis dies, every attached part dies with it — the **death cascade**. This is the most important risk-management lesson in Clankers: putting all your weapons on one chassis means losing all of them in one trade.

— SECTION 06

Resources

Clankers has three resources. None of them are mana.

Compute • The AI's processor cycles

Refreshes **fully** at the start of each of your turns. Formula:

```
compute = min(10, 3 + turn_number)
```

Turn 1 you have 4; turn 2 you have 5; ... turn 7+ you're capped at 10. Compute does NOT carry over between turns. **Spend it or lose it.**

Compute pays for: playing cards from hand (each card prints its compute cost), and activated abilities (e.g., a weapon's "Fire: 1 Compute, exhaust, deal 1 damage").

Build Slots • The chassis's hardpoints

Printed on every chassis: `weapon_slots` and `add_on_slots`. A chassis can carry up to that many attached parts of each type. Slots are **per chassis**, not per player.

Examples: Sparkbot has 1W/1A. Heavy Assembly has 2W/3A. Sentinel Crane has 1W/4A (a wall, not a striker).

Scrap • The salvage pool

Persistent across turns. Starts at 0, caps at 10. Gained by:

- Destroying enemy parts in combat (small amounts via specific cards)
- Reclaim N parts dying (gain N)
- Forge Stoke (+2), MIRTHBOT-1 Core's on-attach trigger (+1)

Spent on alternate or additional costs ("Pay 3 Scrap to deal 3 damage"; "Pay 2 Scrap to return a destroyed weapon").

Hand • NOT a resource

Once per turn at the start of Allocate, you may top off your hand to 7. Hand size is a **floor**, not a ceiling — mid-turn effects can push you above 7 and you stay there. Cards in hand don't expire and don't generate value just by existing. **The deck is your real resource; every card cycled is one card closer to the deathclock.**

WHY NO MANA?

Mana-style accumulating resources reward "playing on curve" — drop a 1-cost on turn 1, 2-cost on turn 2, etc. Compute resets every turn, so the curve becomes: drop your best 4-Compute play on turn 1, your best 5-Compute play on turn 2. The pressure isn't "do I have enough mana?" — it's "can I attach this weapon to a chassis that's still alive at the start of next turn?"

— SECTION 07

Winning and Losing

Primary win: Workshop Breach

Reduce the opposing Core's **Workshop Integrity** to 0. The opposing AI is "destroyed by its own creations escaping containment." A WORKSHOP_BREACHED event fires, the opposing player loses, you win.

Sources of Workshop Integrity damage:

- **Unblocked combat damage:** an attacker's Effective Power that gets through to the Core.
- **Direct damage Transients:** Reroute Power, Scrap Salvo, Big Swing's secondary mode.
- **Containment Failure self-damage:** the deathclock's escalating ticks (see below).

The default starting value is **30** Workshop Integrity. Some Cores start higher (BULWARK-9 at 27, but with regeneration); some start lower (ETHOS-7 at 22 for the trade-off of a Transient-cost discount).

Secondary: Containment Failure (the deathclock)

When **either** player's library reaches **5 cards or fewer**, the Containment Failure clock activates. From that point on, at the end of every turn, both Cores take self-damage:

```
tick 1 → 2 damage  
tick 2 → 4 damage  
tick 3 → 8 damage  
tick 4 → 16 damage
```

This guarantees a winner within ~3 turns of activation. The deathclock is "the AIs accelerating each other's containment failure." It's not slow; it's exponential.

Edge case: mutual annihilation

If both players' Workshop Integrity reaches 0 on the same damage event, the game ends in a draw. Both AIs explode together. The rules allow it. The workshop does not.

WHAT DOES NOT CAUSE A LOSS

- Drawing your last card from your library does not auto-lose (unlike MTG). It activates the deathclock.
- Having no chassis on the Assembly Floor is fine. You can still play parts solo and refill chassis next turn.
- Discarding your entire hand is fine. Refill at Allocate.
- The Core cannot be attacked, targeted, or destroyed by any card effect. Only Workshop Integrity damage matters.

— SECTION 08

Special Mechanics

Synchronize

A keyword on certain swarm chassis. If you control **2 or 3** Synchronize chassis, each one gets +1 Power.

If you control **4 or more**, the chain **over-couples** — every Synchronize chassis gets +0 (the lord effect is inert). This is the Wave 4B over-coupling penalty; it exists to keep wide swarms from snowballing without a cap.

Many Synchronize-payoff cards (Affinity Coil's anthem, Iron Cluster's structure) **also** respect the over-coupling rule. A few per-host buffs (Hum-Lance, Tinker's Frame) do **not** — they apply to their individual host regardless of how many Synchronize chassis are in play.

Crowd Marcher

2/2 · 3 Compute

Chassis · Synchronize · swarm

"Synchronize. (If you control 2-3 Synchronize chassis, this gets +1 Power.)"

Self-Mobile

A keyword on certain weapons and add-ons. A solo (unattached) Self-Mobile part on the Assembly Floor keeps its printed Power Bonus and Integrity Bonus stats even while unattached, instead of being a baseline 1/1.

Self-Mobile is the engine's answer to "I drew a great weapon but no chassis yet." Play the weapon solo this turn; attach it to a chassis next turn (or just let it attack as itself).

Scout Drone

+2/+0 · 3 Compute

Weapon · Self-Mobile · swarm

"Self-Mobile. While unattached, Scout Drone is a 3/2."

Modular

A keyword on certain weapons. Once per turn during Reassemble, you may pay 1 Compute to **detach** a Modular part and **re-attach** it to a different chassis you control with an open slot.

Modular's purpose: rescue a great weapon from a chassis that's about to die. If your Buzzsaw-equipped Iron Spire just took 5 damage and is going to die next turn, you can Modular it onto a fresh chassis at the cost of 1 Compute.

Reclaim N

A keyword on certain parts. When this part is destroyed (by combat, cascade, or direct effect), gain N Scrap.

Reclaim trades part-survival for scrap economy. Brick decks lean on it: Sacrificial Plating (Reclaim 3) plus a Tungsten Walker (cost reduces with scrap) is a turn-3 6/7 chassis for 3 Compute.

Sacrificial Plating

+0/+3 · 2 Compute

Add-On · Reclaim 3 · brick

"When this is destroyed, gain 3 Scrap."

Reticulate

A trigger on certain structures and chassis. **"At the end of your turn, if you played 0 Transients this turn, draw a card."** It rewards decks that **aren't** built on Transient density — typically brick and swarm.

Armor N

A keyword on certain add-ons. When the host chassis takes damage, this add-on may be exhausted to absorb up to N of that damage. Tapped (exhausted) add-ons do not contribute their Integrity Bonus or other static effects until they're ready at Boot.

Armor is a **replacement** effect — you choose to spend it before damage applies. You can stack multiple armor add-ons on the same chassis for a serial defense ("Armor 2 + Armor 3 + Armor 4" absorbs 9 damage across three attacks, one per absorb).

Reactive Shielding

+0/+2 · 3 Compute

Add-On · Armor 3 · artillery

"Armor 3. (Exhaust this to absorb up to 3 damage to host chassis.)"

— SECTION 09

Card Gallery – 151 cards

All 151 cards in the CLAN set, sorted by type and name. Cores list Workshop Integrity in the I column; Weapons list **power_bonus** in P; Add-Ons list **integrity_bonus** in I. Archetype tags: **brick** · **control** · **swarm** · **artillery** · **neutral**.

Cores (6)

NAME	I (HP)	ARCHETYPE	RULES TEXT
Affection.exe	25	SWARM	First chassis you play each turn enters with +1 integrity.
BULWARK-9	27	ARTILLERY	EoT: if 3+ exhausted add-ons, +1 scrap and +1 workshop integrity.
ETHOS-7	22	CONTROL	First Transient each turn costs 1 less Compute (min 0).
FORGE-Δ	25	BRICK	Your Chassis with integrity ≥5 cost 1 less Compute (min 1).
MIRTHBOT-1	23	SWARM	When a part attaches to a friendly chassis, gain 1 scrap.
SUBROUTINE-α	24	CONTROL	Start of Reassemble: may scrap a card to gain 2 Compute this turn.

Chassis (40)

NAME	COST	P/I	SLOTS W/A	ARCHETYPE	RULES TEXT
Affection-Bot	2	2/2	1/2	SWARM	When a part attaches to Affection-Bot, gain 1 scrap.
Apex Hulk	7	7/7	2/3	BRICK	Vanilla apex — turn-7 lockout body.

Bastion Frame	4	1/6	1/4	ARTILLERY	Pay 1 scrap to keep an attached add-on from being exhausted.
Bulwark Frame	4	3/6	2/4	CONTROL	A patient tank with deep add-on stacking.
Carbon-Steel Drudge	3	2/6	1/2	BRICK	Unaffected by armor-skip effects from opposing Transients.
Conga Constructor	3	2/3	2/2	SWARM	When a chassis you control enters, this gets +1 integrity EOT.
Containment Scribe	3	2/4	1/2	CONTROL	When you play a Transient, scry 1.
Containment Sergeant	4	2/5	1/3	ARTILLERY	EoT: if 2+ exhausted add-ons, gain 1 workshop integrity.
Counterweight Walker	5	3/6	1/3	ARTILLERY	When a chassis you control dies, this gets +2 integrity (perm).
Crowd Marcher	3	3/3	2/2	SWARM	Synchronize (inert at 4+ Synchronize chassis).
Embankment	3	1/5	0/3	ARTILLERY	Vanilla; cannot equip weapons.
Endurance Frame	6	4/7	2/3	CONTROL	A patient bulk-tank for the late game.
Foreman's Watch	6	4/6	1/3	ARTILLERY	EoT: if 3+ exhausted add-ons, draw a card.
Foundryman	5	4/6	2/2	BRICK	Attached weapons on Foundryman have +1 power_bonus.
Heavy Assembly	5	5/6	2/3	BRICK	Vanilla heavyweight.
Heuristic Sentry	2	1/3	1/2	CONTROL	ETB: may scrap a card from hand to draw a card.
Hum-Swarm Alpha	4	3/3	1/2	SWARM	Synchronize. Other Synchronize chassis you control have +1 integrity.

Iron Spire	4	3/6	2/2	BRICK	ETB: scrap top of library; if Chassis, put on floor.
Ironclad Foreman	4	4/5	2/2	BRICK	ETB: gain 2 scrap.
Joyful Walker	3	2/2	1/2	SWARM	Synchronize.
Linked Crawler	2	1/2	1/1	SWARM	Synchronize.
Long-Memory Husk	4	2/6	1/3	CONTROL	Reclaim 2 (when destroyed, gain 2 scrap).
Loop Engine	5	4/5	1/2	CONTROL	Start of Reassemble: if you played a Transient, draw.
Magenta Buzzer	2	3/1	1/1	SWARM	Synchronize.
Mortar Lieutenant	4	4/4	1/2	ARTILLERY	When attacks unblocked, deal 1 additional workshop damage.
Plant Foreman	3	2/5	2/2	BRICK	When a friendly chassis integrity ≥ 5 enters, draw a card.
Quickforge Drudge	2	2/2	1/1	SWARM	ETB: attach a Weapon you control to a chassis you control.
Ready-Up Engineer	3	2/4	1/3	ARTILLERY	Start of Boot: ready an additional exhausted add-on you control.
Recursive Sentinel	5	3/5	1/3	CONTROL	When a Transient resolves, this gets +1 power EOT.
Salvager-7	2	1/4	1/2	BRICK	Pay 2 scrap, Reassemble: return destroyed Chassis exhausted.
Sentinel Crane	6	3/8	1/4	ARTILLERY	Vanilla high-end wall.
Skitterswarm	1	1/1	1/1	SWARM	When a part attaches, this gets +1/+1 EOT.
Smelter Frame	3	3/5	2/2	BRICK	When a weapon attaches, this gets +1 integrity.
Sparkbot	1	2/1	1/1	SWARM	A small, eager bot.

Subroutine Core	3	2/4	2/2	CONTROL	When you play a Transient, this gets +1 power EOT.
Tinkerling	1	1/1	1/1	SWARM	ETB: attach a part you control to a chassis you control.
Tungsten Walker	7	6/7	2/3	BRICK	Costs 1 less for each scrap in your pool when played.
Vault Chassis	4	2/7	1/4	ARTILLERY	Vanilla wall.
Whirring Initiate	1	1/2	1/1	SWARM	ETB: draw a card if you control another chassis.
Workshop Prototype	2	2/3	1/2	NEUTRAL	Vanilla 2-drop usable in any deck.

Weapons (40)

NAME	COST	+P	SLOT	ARCHETYPE	RULES TEXT
Affection Spike	1	+1	1	SWARM	When attaches, draw a card if you control 3+ chassis.
Anvil Drone	3	+3	1	BRICK	Host's first attack each turn deals +1 damage.
Apex Coilgun	5	+6	2	BRICK	Slot cost 2. Modular.
Bolt-Driver Mk-II	2	+3	1	BRICK	Vanilla.
Burnout Cannon	5	+4	1	ARTILLERY	When host attacks unblocked, defending player mills 1.
Buzzsaw Arm	1	+2	1	BRICK	Vanilla.
BUZZSAW MK-III	3	+4	1	BRICK	Vanilla mid-game striker.
Cipher Rotor	4	+3	1	CONTROL	Self-Mobile. Solo: 4/1.
Containment Lance	4	+5	1	CONTROL	When host attacks, defender can't ready add-ons next Boot.
Containment Pike	3	+3	1	ARTILLERY	Reclaim 2.
Containment Whip	3	+2	1	ARTILLERY	When host attacks, exhaust an add-on for +1 damage.
Decoder Spike	1	+1	1	CONTROL	When you play your first Transient each turn, draw a card.
Forge-Cannon	5	+5	2	BRICK	Slot cost 2. When attached, host has +1 integrity.
Heavy Spike	2	+2	1	BRICK	Reclaim 2.
Heavy Watchpost	4	+2	1	ARTILLERY	Host cannot attack. When host blocks, host has armor 2.
Helping Claw	1	+1	1	SWARM	When you play another chassis, +1 power until EoT.

Heuristic Lance	3	+3	1	CONTROL	When you play a Transient, this gets +1 power EOT.
Hum-Lance	3	+2	1	SWARM	If host has Synchronize, this is +3/+0 instead.
Joybuzzer	1	+1	1	SWARM	Self-Mobile. Solo: 2/1.
Logic Lance	2	+3	1	CONTROL	When this attaches, scry 1.
Magenta Coil	3	+3	1	SWARM	Self-Mobile. Solo: 4/2.
Memory Blade	3	+3	1	CONTROL	When host attacks, mill 1; if Transient, draw a card.
Modular Railgun	4	+4	1	BRICK	Modular (1 Compute, Reassemble: move to another chassis).
Recoil Mount	2	+2	1	BRICK	Pay 1 Compute, exhaust: deal 1 damage to a chassis.
Recursion Hook	4	+3	1	CONTROL	When destroyed, return a Transient from scrap to hand.
Riot Baton	2	+2	1	ARTILLERY	When host blocks, this gets +1 power until end of turn.
Riot Mortar	4	+3	1	ARTILLERY	When host attacks unblocked, deal 2 workshop damage instead.
Riveter Mk-I	2	+2	1	NEUTRAL	Vanilla.
Salvage Cleaver	3	+3	1	BRICK	When host destroys a chassis, gain 2 scrap.
Scout Drone	3	+2	1	SWARM	Self-Mobile. Solo: 3/2.
Sentinel Cannon	3	+3	1	ARTILLERY	When host destroys a chassis, gain 1 workshop integrity.
Spare Coilgun	3	+3	1	NEUTRAL	Vanilla.
Spark Whip	2	+2	1	SWARM	Self-Mobile. Solo: 3/1.
Standard Issue Blaster	1	+1	1	NEUTRAL	Vanilla.
Stinger Pack	1	+1	1	SWARM	Self-Mobile. Solo: 2/1.
Stunner Arm	2	+1	1	ARTILLERY	1 Compute, exhaust host: opp chassis can't attack next turn.

Subroutine Driver	2	+2	1	CONTROL	Reclaim 1.
Tickle-Saw	3	+3	1	SWARM	Self-Mobile. Solo: 4/1.
Tinkerblade	2	+2	1	SWARM	When this attaches, gain 1 scrap.
Workshop Wrench	1	+1	1	NEUTRAL	Pay 1 Compute, exhaust: ready one exhausted add-on.

Add-Ons (35)

NAME	COST	+P/+I	ARCHETYPE	RULES TEXT
Affection.exe (Add-On)	2	+1/+1	SWARM	Self-Mobile. Solo: 2/2.
Affinity Coil	4	+1/+2	SWARM	Synchronize chassis you control have +1 power.
Brace Plate	2	+0/+2	BRICK	Reclaim 2.
Bulwark Brace	3	+0/+4	BRICK	Vanilla.
Bunker Cradle	4	+0/+4	ARTILLERY	Armor 4 (exhaust to absorb up to 4 damage).
Charm Module	1	+0/+1	SWARM	When host attacks unblocked, gain 1 scrap.
Containment Lattice	2	+0/+2	CONTROL	Armor 2.
Containment Lining	3	+0/+3	ARTILLERY	Armor 2. While 3+ attached add-ons exhausted, host +1 power.
Coolant Cradle	1	+0/+1	ARTILLERY	Pay 1 scrap, Reassemble: ready this add-on.
Cooldown Harness	2	+0/+2	CONTROL	Start of Boot: ready an additional exhausted add-on.
Counterweight Sleeve	2	+0/+2	ARTILLERY	When host blocks, host gets +1 integrity until end of combat.
Curiosity Routine	1	+0/+1	SWARM	Self-Mobile. On attach: attach another solo part.
Foundry Bracer	3	+1/+3	BRICK	When host attacks, this gets +1 power until end of combat.
Glee Plating	2	+0/+2	SWARM	Reclaim 1.
Heuristic Layer	2	+0/+1	CONTROL	When you play a Transient, draw a card. (Once per turn.)
Joybuzzer Sleeve	1	+1/+0	SWARM	Self-Mobile. Solo: 2/1.
Logic Buffer	3	+0/+3	CONTROL	Armor 3.

Lugnut Cradle	1	+0/+1	BRICK	Host has +1 integrity for each weapon attached.
Patient Frame	3	+0/+4	CONTROL	While host has 4+ damage marked, host has +2 power.
Reactive Shielding	3	+0/+2	ARTILLERY	Armor 3.
Reactor Shell	4	+1/+4	BRICK	Pay 2 scrap, Reassemble: ready this add-on.
Recursive Tape	4	+1/+3	CONTROL	When this is destroyed, draw 2 cards.
Reinforced Plating	2	+0/+2	BRICK	Vanilla.
Riot Plating	3	+0/+2	ARTILLERY	Armor 2. When absorbs damage, deal 1 to attacker.
Sacrificial Plating	2	+0/+3	BRICK	Reclaim 3.
Soft-Cycle Ridge	3	+0/+2	CONTROL	Armor 2. When absorbs damage, draw a card.
Speedlink	2	+0/+1	SWARM	When attaches, draw a card if you control 3+ chassis.
Spotter Rig	2	+0/+2	ARTILLERY	When host blocks, draw a card.
Subroutine Dampener	1	+0/+1	CONTROL	When a Transient resolves, host gets +1 integrity EOT.
Thick Hide	3	+0/+3	BRICK	Armor 2.
Tinker's Frame	3	+1/+1	SWARM	If host has Synchronize, this is +1/+2 instead.
Tungsten Carapace	4	+1/+4	BRICK	Armor 3.
Vault Bracer	2	+0/+3	ARTILLERY	Vanilla.
Wired Toolkit	2	+0/+1	SWARM	When this attaches, draw a card.

Transients (17)

NAME	COST	ARCHETYPE	RULES TEXT
Big Swing	4	BRICK	Target chassis deals damage = effective power to chassis/Core.
Burnout Protocol	4	ARTILLERY	If deathclock active, opponent takes double damage at EoT.
Containment Recall	3	ARTILLERY	Return destroyed add-on from scrap to floor exhausted/unattached.
Diagnostic Sweep	2	CONTROL	Scry 3 (look at top 3, scrap any, rest on top in any order).
Forge Stoke	1	BRICK	Gain 2 scrap.
Garbage Collector	3	CONTROL	Return a Transient from your scrap heap to your hand.
Hammer-On	2	BRICK	Target chassis you control gets +3 power until end of turn.
Heuristic Loop	2	CONTROL	Draw 2; if 3+ Transients in scrap, draw 1 more.
Iron Audit	3	BRICK	Scrap a chassis from hand; put it on the floor exhausted.
Joybomb	1	SWARM	Each chassis you control gets +1 power until end of turn.
Patch	1	CONTROL	Target chassis you control regains all damage marked.
Recall to Workshop	2	SWARM	Return a chassis you control to your hand.
Repair Subroutine	2	ARTILLERY	Ready up to 2 exhausted add-ons you control. (Does not heal damage.)
Reroute Power	1	CONTROL	Target chassis deals damage = attached-weapon count.
Scrap Salvo	2	NEUTRAL	Pay 3 scrap: deal 3 damage to a chassis or Core.

Subroutine Cascade	4	CONTROL	Draw 3; next Transient this turn costs 2 less (min 0).
Swarm Surge	4	SWARM	Each Synchronize chassis gets +1/+1 until end of turn.

Structures (13)

NAME	COST	ARCHETYPE	RULES TEXT
Auxiliary Bench	1	NEUTRAL	Pay 1 scrap, Reassemble: free-attach a solo part.
Compounding Buttreass	3	BRICK	Your chassis with integrity ≥ 5 have +1 power.
Compute Trickle	3	CONTROL	Start of Boot: gain 1 Compute (above cap, this turn).
Containment Baffle	3	ARTILLERY	Opposing chassis with power ≥ 4 pay 1 extra Compute to attack.
Heavy Forge	4	BRICK	Your Weapons cost 1 less Compute (min 1).
Iron Cluster	4	SWARM	Each Synchronize chassis you control has +1 integrity.
Mass-Production Line	2	SWARM	Your chassis cost ≤ 2 enter with +1/+0 (this turn).
Public Telemetry	3	NEUTRAL	EoT: if 0 Transients played, gain 1 Compute next turn.
Recursive Observatory	3	CONTROL	Reticulate (EoT: if no Transients played, draw a card).
Reinforced Bay	2	BRICK	Your chassis enter with 1 prevented damage.
Shared Bus	2	NEUTRAL	First part you play each turn costs 1 less (min 0).
Swarm Beacon	3	SWARM	Your chassis have +1 power if you control 3+ chassis.
Workshop Sprinkler	4	ARTILLERY	EoT: ready an additional exhausted add-on you control.

SECTION 10

Quick Reference

Turn order cheat sheet

1	BOOT	Untap. Compute = $\min(10, 3 + \text{turn})$. Structure upkeep.
2	ALLOCATE	MAY draw to 7. (Decline to slow your deathclock.)
3	ASSEMBLE	Play / attach / activate. Pay Compute. Hearthstone-style resolution.
4	COMBAT	You declare attackers; opp blocks 1-for-1. Damage simultaneous.
5	REASSEMBLE	Second Assemble window. Modular weapons relocate. Patch heals.
6	CLEANUP	EOT triggers. Damage persists. Pass priority.

Resource reference

RESOURCE	START	PER TURN	CAP	CARRYOVER
Compute	0	$+\min(\text{cap}, 3+T)$	10	No
Scrap	0	from kills/cards	10	Yes
Workshop Integrity	30*	— (combat-driven)	30*	Yes
Hand	7	refill to 7 once/turn	soft	Yes

* Some Cores ship with different starting Workshop Integrity. BULWARK-9 starts at 27; ETHOS-7 starts at 22.

Common timing Q&A

Q: WHEN DOES SYNCHRONIZE ACTIVATE?

The lord chain checks at action time: if you control exactly 2 or 3 Synchronize chassis, all of them get +1 power. With 4+, the bonus is 0 (over-couples). With 1, just the printed stats — no bonus.

Q: CAN I ATTACH A PART TO AN OPPOSING CHASSIS?

No. The same-controller restriction is enforced at attach time. Sabotage-style cross-controller attachment is a future-set hook.

Q: WHEN DOES ARMOR GET SPENT?

Armor N is a **replacement** effect on a DAMAGE event. You declare you're spending Armor before the damage applies, exhaust the add-on, and the damage payload reduces by N. Once damage applies, you can't retroactively spend armor.

Q: DOES DAMAGE ON A CHASSIS HEAL BETWEEN TURNS?

No. Damage marked on a chassis persists indefinitely. To clear it, play the Patch Transient (full heal of one chassis), or let the chassis die and rebuild.

Q: SOLO PARTS CAN BLOCK, RIGHT?

Yes. Unattached weapons and add-ons on the Assembly Floor are baseline 1/1 (or higher with Self-Mobile) and validate as legal blockers. They'll die to most attacks but they absorb the damage.

Q: WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN PATCH AND REPAIR SUBROUTINE?

Patch (ETHOS, 1 Compute) full-heals a chassis's damage_marked.

Repair Subroutine (BULWARK, 2 Compute) **readies** up to 2 exhausted add-ons — it does NOT heal damage. They look similar in the rulebook; they do completely different things.

Q: WHEN DOES THE DEATHCLOCK START?

The moment **either** library reaches 5 cards. Not when both empty (that was the original rule, changed in Wave 4C). Whichever library hits 5 first triggers Containment Failure. From then on every End-of-Turn does escalating damage (2, 4, 8, 16, ...) to both Cores.

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